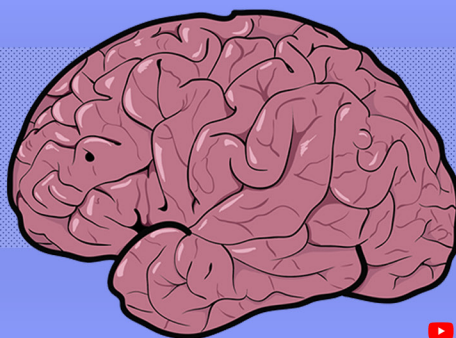


the



Free the Brain
Show

 www.youtube.com/freethebrain

curiosity

honesty

style

Free...theBrain

Synopsis

Free the Brain is a YouTube channel dedicated to exploring all the questions that we realize we don't quite have the answer to. Why is white chocolate white? Why shouldn't we drink Alcohol while on Antibiotics? Why do snails come out on rainy days? These and more are some of the riddles being investigated, and the fascinating part is that no answer can be universal or without a context. Facts and observations merely lead deeper into the rabbit hole, generating even more puzzles to be solved. As one of Xeno's paradoxes states "whenever the circle of knowledge grows, its sides encounter a larger amount of unknowns than before." The chain of information is infinite.

Free the Brain is narrated and directed by Neuropsychology graduate Chris Edrev and his persona "Brain guy" – a bi-polar character who is never quite convinced in anything in the world. The show is accompanied by the ambient music of famous "Minecraft" and "Stranger things" soundtrack composer – C418. Free the Brain is a cinematic learning experience utilizing animation, motion graphics and vectorised photos and images all converted into the same cartoony artistic style. For every question asked, you can expect an explorative answer that looks to dig deep. Free the Brain is not so much about the solutions, as much as the wonderful journey of inquiry.

Project information

Producer	Christo Edrev
Production company	FreetheBrain
3-line synopsis	Free the Brain is a YouTube channel dedicated to exploring all the questions that we realize we don't quite have the answer to. Facts and observations merely lead deeper into the rabbit hole, generating even more puzzles to be solved. This show is not so much about the solutions, as much as the wonderful journey of inquiry.
Director	Hristo Todorov
Writer	Christo Edrev



Project title	Free the Brain
Genre	Factology/ Documentary
Distribution platforms	YouTube
Stage of development	Early development
Estimated monthly production budget	2 500 EUR
Partners/ co-producers	7 Talents Kinematograf media
Contact details	Hadzhi Dimitar quarter, Vassil Petleshkov str 36-38, apartment 6/3 1510, Sofia, Bulgaria christo.edrev@gmail.com tel. +359 886 345 509

Producer's note of intention

Free the Brain has been my brain child for several years now and I believe the time to realize it has finally come.

It was initially meant to complement my hobbies of video editing and graphic design but with time it has grown into so much more - a symbol of self-actualization that I have vowed to complete.

At first envisioned as a one man show, it will run like this in its initial stages, but the plan is to gather a team of professionals once the project starts growing. I would like to remain the host and co-writer, but a main scriptwriter, camera man and editor will be required.

My goal is for the show to release a 10-minute episode at least once per week. The first several episodes can be created without funds as a pilot series. Once a viewerbase has been established, there are a number of monetizing strategies that will help the show grow and be profitable.

Those are: YouTube ad revenue, viewer donations, merchandise, and sponsorships/ co-production deals. The first 3 depend on the organic success of the show and the size of the viewer base. The latter depends more on the appeal of our concept and brand. We would be inclined to sign co-production deals with multi-channel networks or sponsors. There is already a possibility to work in partnership with the Bulgarian video platform Vbox7.com, which would allow us to simultaneously release our videos in English on YouTube, and in Bulgarian on Vbox7. This will require a double script and extended production and postproduction process, of course, but I believe the extra effort will be worthwhile, since the Bulgarian audience brings an important sentimental appeal, due to Bulgaria being my country of origin. Furthermore, the niche is uncontested in Bulgaria still.

In case of further outside interest, we would love to include more co-producers and sponsors as that will increase the production value of the show and thus its chance of success. The goal for Free the Brain is for it to become a global show, which a unique and enjoyable aesthetic.

Director's note of intention

Free the Brain is as much a talk- and info-show, as it is a real-life piece of moving graphic design. There is a huge emphasis on the branding aspect, as well as the use of unique ambient electronic music, following the example of the pioneering factology show "Vsauce". The soundtrack of choice for FtB is a variety of creative commons pieces by the famous Minecraft composer C418.

The show will be hosted by Christo Edrev in his stage persona – "Brain Guy" – a bipolar psychology student that is never quite convinced in anything in the world. The function of the host here is to create a performance, rather than being a mere informer.



Composer C418 - creates rich, ambient, transe-inducing music



One of the inspirations behind "FreetheBrain" - Michael Stevens and his quirky, informative show "Vsauce"

Cinematographers's note of intention

The cinematography will be vibrant and colorful with lense flares, lots of close-up and wide-lense shots and an emphasis on a shallow focal point with a blurred background. All this will create a unique, psychedelic visual style, that hopefully reminds the viewer of what we see through a microscope or magnifying glass, and inspires a sense of awe and exploration.

The editing will try to complement the colorful, cartoony style with fast dynamic cuts from host to topic, intermixed with irregular, lengthy, immersive showcase shots of whatever is being illustrated. All this will be complemented with graphic elements and animation. There will be a large emphasis on clear and elegantly incorporated floating text that will be as interactive as possible. The goal is for text to be part of the experience and add an extra layer of information that the viewer is incentivized to explore at their own pace. The show will strive to be a cinematic textbook.

Biographies



Christo Edrev - Producer, Writer, Host

I am a Neuropsychology graduate and soon to be Master in Film management from NATFA. I have spent many years working for and learning from my family's business - Art College for media arts - Sofia, where I have participated in the production of a multitude of short documentary and fiction films. I am a movie editor and graphic designer and have worked as such for the PR company ABCommunications, as well as for the media - Channel 3.



Hristo Todorov - Director, Writer

I am a graduate of the Burgas professional highscool for mechanical electronics. Curenly studying cinematography at Art College for media arts - Sofia and programming at the Software University (Softuni). I've made 6 short films so far with a focus on history and general factology. The most succesful ones are "Far away, from ancient Persia" - a documentary about persian cats, and "The Panorama" - an exploration of the Pleven liberation monument.



Lachezar Dimitrov - Cinematographer

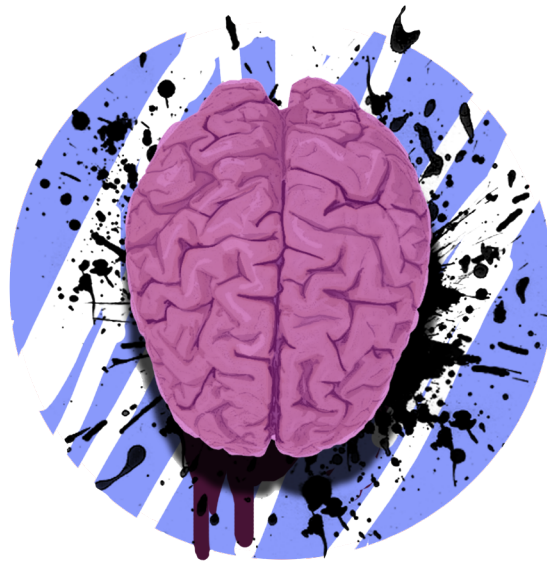
I studied cinematography in the national academy for film FAMU in the Czech Republic, and graduated with cinematography in from the Northern Film School in Leeds, UK. Currently undertaking an MA in stills photography at the national academy of theatre and film arts in Sofia. I mostly work as a freelance cinematographer, for the Bulgarian National Television and other national broadcasters as well as on independent projects and commercials. Some of my work includes the award winning documentaries "Welcome to the show" and "I AM VADER".

Marketing strategy

Our Marketing strategy will primarily involve the YouTube algorithm, since the platform itself is designed in a way that automatically promotes content that it deems watchable. This happens through a machine learning algorithm that observes viewer retention and engagement through factors such as “like to dislike” ratio, “number of comments”, and average watch time/ percentage watched. Before the algorithm can start working, however, certain factors are important for discoverability within the YouTube platform. Those are the Title, Thumbnail and Tags of the video. The title needs to be succinct, on point, and intriguing. For this reason the title format will contain a question – the main topic of the video, and some playlist information denoting wzhich episode of the series this is. Such numbering is useful so viewers can keep track of which episodes they have already seen. Because binge watching is a known factor with series like these, we will only premiere the show on the internet when we already have at least 3-5 finished videos, so all new viewers can stumble upon a library of content and thus have more to explore on discovery, as well as know what to expect in the future. Regarding Thumbnails (small pictures that serve as posters of the video), the philosophy here is to have a clean but colorful thumbnail that can catch the idea. And emphasis on details and textures is a good philosophy, because the thumbnail is small and the depicted object needs to be large enough to be seen. Finally Tags are a way of describing the video contents so it is discoverable by users through search engines. Special care will be given to describing every episode thoroughly, so that our videos actually match user searches on the topic.

Outside of YouTube we will focus on promoting the show through Reddit and collaborations with similar themed channels.

The core target audience is teenagers and university students aged 14-25, but the show should be clear enough for gifted younger schoolkids, and stylish and informative enough for adults.





FreetheBrain 2019